



On an even keel: IPL 2024 will allow bowlers to deliver two bouncers an over to facilitate a more even contest between bat and ball. SPORTZPICS / IPL

the trials and tribulations of the Ranji player. Whenever the superstars want to get their form back, they are quick to go and play the Ranji Trophy, but speaking out for their Ranji brothers seems to be a complete 'No, No'.

There was also some talk during the Ranji season about the need to have a gap between matches to allow for some recovery of minor injuries, and that is something that needs to be given some thought. Many years ago, when Shri Jagmohan Dalmiya was the president of the BCCI, he started a Captains and Coaches Conclave at

the end of the season where the captains and coaches of all the state teams gathered in one city and talked about what they felt needed to be done.

This was most refreshing because, even though it wasn't possible to implement all the suggestions, the fact that the captains and coaches felt that they were being given a hearing by the BCCI made them feel that much more attached to Indian cricket.

Perhaps this Conclave could be revived on the eve of the BCCI Apex Council meeting so that they would be aware of how those who play the

non-glamorous but still national championship, the Ranji Trophy, feel about Indian cricket.

Let me add that, having attended all the previous conclaves as chairman of the BCCI Technical Committee, not once was there any discussion about remuneration.

All the talk at the conclaves was simply about Ranji cricket and what the captains and coaches felt could be done to enhance the quality and standard even further. It might not be possible to do the conclave this time, but it certainly is worth giving a thought from next season onward.



Since those cricket players who make themselves available to play most of the Test matches are now going to be rewarded with double or triple their fees, it would be terrific if the same yardstick was used for players who played the Ranji Trophy.